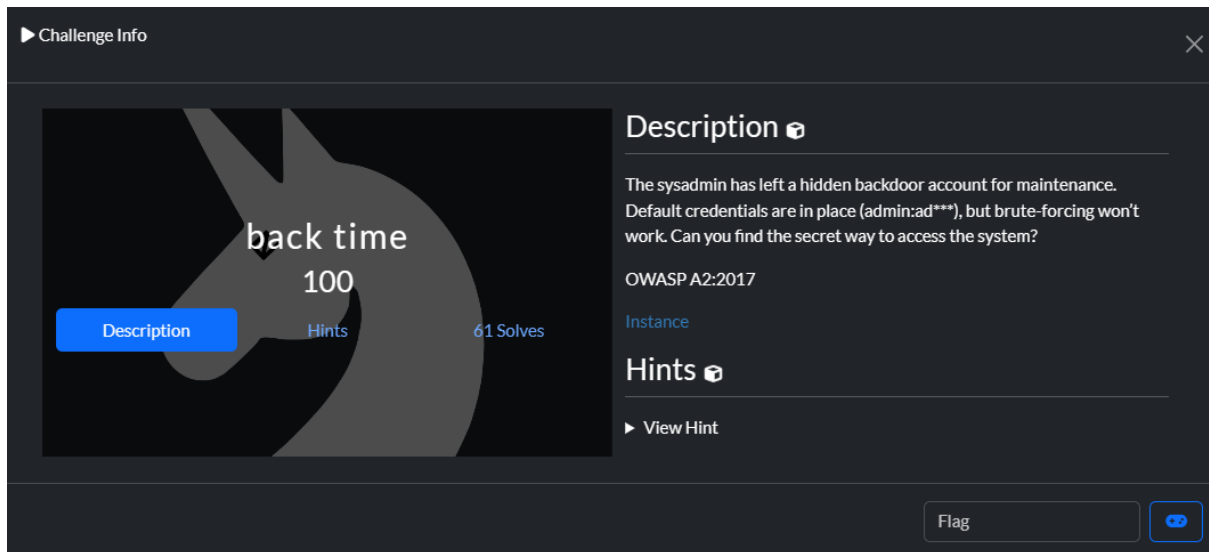
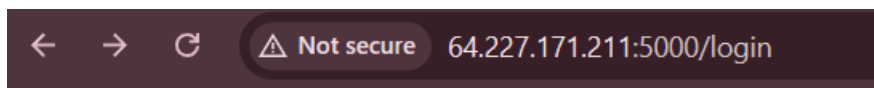


Challenge Name: back time - 100 (WEB)



The Setup

Visiting the challenge URL shows a very simple login form:



Login

Username:

Password:

BSides Noida 0x03

The description explicitly mentioned a hidden backdoor account and that default credentials were in place (**hinting admin:ad*****), and it also warned that brute-forcing wouldn't work. The phrase "hidden" suggested some kind of invisible character or whitespace trick.

What I tried

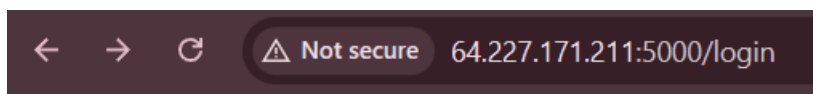
Because brute force was discouraged, I focused on small, human mistakes and invisible quirks:

1. Tried common default credentials (e.g., **admin:admin**, **admin:admin123**) — no luck.
2. Considered invisible characters (**trailing/leading spaces**, **zero-width spaces**) and white-space mistakes developers sometimes leave.
3. Tried variants with spaces:
 - **Username:** **admin + trailing space (admin)**
 - **Password:** **admin**

This combination logged in successfully.

Result

After submitting:



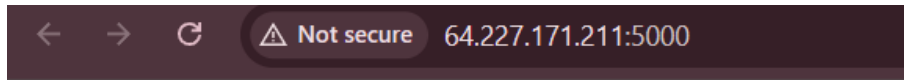
Login

Username:

Password:

BSides Noida 0x03

The page returned:



Welcome admin

FLAG: SPL{87b441720681ba85662b69df1bd41711}

[Logout](#)

Flag captured.

Why this worked

Developers sometimes create maintenance/backdoor accounts and copy/paste credentials into config files, editors, or deployment scripts that accidentally include invisible characters (**trailing spaces, non-breaking spaces, zero-width spaces**). The authentication check stored the username with that invisible character, so only the exact string (**including the space**) worked — a form of accidental obfuscation, not security.

The challenge hint that “brute-forcing won’t work” nudged us toward a manual, human-readable fix rather than automated attacks.

Final Notes

This was a nice exercise in thinking like a human rather than a script: small, invisible details can be the intended vulnerability. Always try simple manual checks (**whitespace, unicode oddities**) when brute force is explicitly discouraged.

Flag: SPL{87b441720681ba85662b69df1bd41711}

~By: 1nf1n1ty